

Subject: Senior SRE/Platform Engineering Position – Narendranath Panda

Dear Hiring Team,

With nearly two decades of experience architecting and scaling enterprise-grade distributed systems and over 12 years specializing in SRE and platform engineering, I was excited to discover the open position at Sweed. My background in designing, deploying, and optimizing scalable cloud-native platforms—particularly on AWS, Kubernetes, and infrastructure automation—aligns perfectly with the technical challenges Sweed faces as it scales its all-in-one cannabis retail platform across multi-location operations.

Why I'm Excited About Sweed

I'm genuinely impressed by Sweed's comprehensive POS platform and its sophisticated feature integration (eCommerce, loyalty, marketing, compliance, and analytics). The technical execution required to deliver such a cohesive, multi-tenant system serving enterprise cannabis retailers at scale resonates deeply with my professional passion. The opportunity to apply my expertise in building resilient, highly available platforms to support Sweed's mission of empowering cannabis retailers with enterprise-grade technology is exactly the kind of challenge I thrive on solving.

What I Bring to Your Team

Proven expertise at massive scale: At Nokia, I orchestrated the zero-downtime migration and operation of 1000+ Edge Kubernetes clusters and 15+ Data Center Kubernetes clusters across 5 global locations, demonstrating my ability to manage complex, distributed infrastructure reliably. This hands-on experience with Kubernetes, EKS, AWS, Terraform, Helm, and GitOps directly translates to the scalable architecture decisions Sweed needs as it grows.

Platform reliability and observability: I architected and deployed a scalable observability and telemetry stack (Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, OpenTelemetry) that improved system reliability while reducing infrastructure costs by 5%. For a POS platform serving cannabis retailers where downtime directly impacts revenue, this operational rigor is critical. Similarly, I designed SLI/SLO frameworks that ensured 99.95% platform availability across mission-critical systems—the same reliability standards Sweed's customers depend on daily.

Developer velocity through automation: I architected a standardized CI/CD workflow (GitLab CI/ArgoCD) that reduced deployment cycles by 50%, enabling rapid feature delivery while maintaining quality. This is essential for Sweed's product-centric organization competing in a fast-moving market where feature velocity matters.

Cross-functional leadership: Beyond infrastructure, I directed a 15-engineer DevOps team and collaborated deeply with teams across operations, compliance, security, and product ownership. This experience fostering a culture of automation and proactive problem-solving—while aligning technical decisions with business objectives—will help Sweed scale both its platform and engineering organization as it grows.

Why Now

I'm actively seeking a role where I can apply my architectural expertise and leadership experience toward building world-class infrastructure for a product that meaningfully impacts its customers' businesses. Sweed's focus on delivering an integrated, enterprise-grade platform for cannabis retail—eliminating the friction of managing multiple disparate systems—represents exactly the kind of technical challenge and business impact I'm looking for.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my experience in designing, operating, and scaling distributed systems can accelerate Sweed's platform engineering initiatives and support your aggressive growth trajectory. My resume provides further detail on my technical qualifications and accomplishments.

Thank you for considering my application. I'm eager to discuss how I can contribute to Sweed's success.

Best regards,

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